You can do something similar in factory_bot:

```
factory :project do
  name "Project Runway"
  start_date { 1.week.ago }
end
```

Although this technique works quite well for keeping test data a consistent relative distance from the test time, it's less helpful if you're trying to test based on the exact value of one of the dates—for example, if you're testing an output value or format. With the first, static set of fixture data, you could write the following:

```
it "displays project date in this goofy format" do
  expect(projects(:runway).goofy_start_date).to eq("2018 1 January")
end
```

This test is a lot more difficult to write if you don't explicitly know the value of the project's start_date.

Stubbing Time

Another option for managing date logic in tests is to "freeze" time by using a stub to explicitly specify what time Ruby reports when you ask for the current time. Rails has also added support for this feature with the methods ActiveSupport::Testing::TimeHelpers#travel and ActiveSupport::Testing::TimeHelpers#travel_to. In the past I've used the Timecop gem,[6] but in the interest of keeping things in house, as it were, I'll use the newer ActiveSupport syntax.

The travel_to method is effectively a superspecific mock-object package: it stubs out Date.today and Time.now, allowing you to explicitly set the effective date for your tests. Using this, the original test could be rewritten as follows:

```
it "finds recently started projects" do
  travel_to(Date.parse("2018-02-10"))
  actual = Project.find_recently_started(6.months)
  expect(actual.size).to eq(3)
end
```

The travel_to method stubs the current date and time methods to the date passed as the argument: in this case, February 10, 2018. Time does not move for the duration of the test.

A separate method, travel, allows you to specify the duration of the time change rather than the absolute target, as in travel 1.month. This is particularly useful when you need time to pass during the course of a test, as in loan calculations.

6. https://github.com/travisjeffery/timecop